

Academic Writing & Assignment

Week 2: Lesson 1



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■

Lesson 1



Today we will cover:

- Referencing and Plagiarism
- Paraphrasing
- The use of AI to help with paraphrasing

Finding literature



- Most of the books/articles you'll need can be found in the LSE Library Catalogue: [Search](#)
- The Library also has a range of useful databases i.e. “collections of key online resources for your subject area”: [Databases \(lse.ac.uk\)](#)
- The best place to find literature for your assignment might be the reading lists found on the Moodle sites of your MSc courses – and will help you get a head start on reading for your degree.
- You could also explore Departmental Online Reading Lists: [Reading List | Find lists \(lse.ac.uk\)](#)
- Finally, Google Scholar is usually helpful: <https://scholar.google.co.uk/>

If you need help



The Library offer help in multiple ways:

- Online
- In person
- Through training courses
- Through dedicated librarians

See: [Getting help \(lse.ac.uk\)](https://lse.ac.uk/help)

- LSE does not have a single standard method for citing and referencing and Departments can have different requirements. It is very important to check your student handbook or ask your academic supervisor to be clear on what is expected for your work.
- If your department has not specified the referencing style, then it is your choice (APA 7 seems to be the most common). You should remain consistent and not mix your referencing styles. Choosing a specific style will make it easier to find and follow rules for each reference.

Common Styles:

- APA 7 [APA Style](#)
- Chicago [Chicago-Style](#)
- Oscola (for law) [Oscola](#)

Referencing Software:

- The most commonly used software at LSE are:
 - [EndNote](#)
 - [Mendeley](#)
 - [Zotero](#).
- You can also use [Cite Them Right](#)

For more advice, see: [Citing and referencing \(lse.ac.uk\)](#)

Task



- Explore the links and find THREE sources which might be helpful for your assignment.
- Choose a referencing style and create references for the texts you found



... the use of any work of others without proper referencing, whether published or not, and can include the work of other students.



Academic Misconduct



Read what LSE has to say about 'Academic Misconduct' here:
[Assessment Discipline \(lse.ac.uk\)](https://www.lse.ac.uk/assessment-discipline)



Paraphrasing



- Paraphrasing is restating another piece of writing in new words while retaining the original meaning.
- **It's a good idea to paraphrase instead of quoting in most cases because:**
 - Paraphrasing shows that you fully understand the meaning of a text
 - Your own voice remains dominant throughout your paper
 - Quotes reduce the readability of your text

A good paraphrase ...



- Has mostly different vocabulary (but can keep some phrases, especially those that cannot be rephrased)
- Has a different sentence structure to the original
- Retains the same meaning

See Pages 4 - 5

Imagine you were paraphrasing this text



The best explanation for the British location of the industrial revolution is found by studying demand factors. By the early eighteenth-century high wages and cheap energy were both features of the British economy. Consequently, the mechanisation of industry through such inventions such as the steam engine and mechanical spinning was profitable because employers were able to economise on labour by spending on coal. At that time, no other country had this particular combination of expensive labour and abundant fuel. (Allen, 2014)

Can you think of synonyms for these words?



The best **explanation** for the British **location of the industrial revolution** is found by studying demand factors. By the early eighteenth-century high **wages** and cheap energy were both **features** of the British economy. **Consequently**, the mechanisation of industry through such inventions as the steam engine and mechanical spinning was profitable because employers were able **to economise** on labour by spending on coal. At that time, no other country had this particular combination of expensive labour and abundant fuel.

Can you think of synonyms for the words below?



- Explanation
- Location of the industrial revolution
- Wages
- Features
- Consequently
- To economise
- Reason
- Birthplace
- Pay / Salaries
- Qualities / Characteristics
- Thus / As a result...
- To save

Alternative word forms



If you were paraphrasing this sentence: *The **best explanation** for the British location of the industrial revolution is found by studying demand factors.*

You could use a synonym for 'explanation' e.g. *Allen (2014) claims the **best reason** for...*

Or you could use an alternative word form for 'explanation' e.g. *According to Allen (2014), the location of the industrial revolution **can be best explained by**....*

What other word forms do these words have?



The best **explanation** for the British location of the industrial revolution is found by **studying** demand factors. By the early eighteenth century high wages and cheap energy were both features of the British economy. Consequently, the **mechanisation** of industry through such inventions as the steam engine and mechanical spinning was profitable because employers were able to **economise** on labour by spending on coal. At that time, no other country had this particular **combination** of expensive labour and abundant fuel.

What are other word forms can you think of for these words?



Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
Explanation			
	Studying		
Mechanism			
	Economise		
Combination			

What are other word forms can you think of for these words?



Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
Explanation	Explain	X	X
Study	Studying	Studiosuos	Studiously
Mechanism	Mechanise	Mechanical	Mechanically
Economy Economics	Economise	Economic Economical	Economically
Combination	Combine	Combined	X

Different word forms



Can you rewrite these sentences using a different word form of the words in green?

1. The best explanation for the British location of the industrial revolution is found by **studying** demand factors.
2. Consequently, the **mechanisation** of industry through such inventions as the steam engine and mechanical spinning was profitable...
3. ... because employers were able to **economise** on labour by spending on coal.
4. At that time, no other country had this particular **combination** of expensive labour and abundant fuel.

Possible answers



Can you rewrite these sentences using a different word form of the words in green?

1. The best explanation for the British location of the industrial revolution is found by **studying** / **the study of** demand factors.
2. Consequently, **the mechanisation of** / **mechanising** industry through such inventions as the steam engine and mechanical spinning was profitable...
3. ... because employers were able to **economise on** / **be economical with** labour by spending on coal.
4. At that time, no other country **had this particular combination of** / **combined** expensive labour and abundant fuel **in this way**.

Note: these sentences would not be successful paraphrases because they are too similar to the original

Subject specific vocabulary



- Sometimes it is not appropriate to change vocabulary.
- For example, if you look for a synonym for 'globalisation', the word 'globalism' is suggested.
- But, while related, 'globalism' and 'globalisation' are different concepts. Globalism is an ideology based on the belief that people, information, and goods should be able to cross national borders unrestricted. Globalisation refers to the spread of technology, products, information, and jobs across nations.

What words would you keep in this passage?



The best explanation for the British location of the industrial revolution is found by studying demand factors. By the early eighteenth century high wages and cheap energy were both features of the British economy. Consequently, the mechanisation of industry through such inventions as the steam engine and mechanical spinning was profitable because employers were able to economise on labour by spending on coal. At that time, no other country had this particular combination of expensive labour and abundant fuel.

What words would you keep?



The best explanation for the British location of the industrial revolution is found by studying demand factors. By the early eighteenth-century high wages and cheap energy were both features of the British economy. Consequently, the mechanisation of industry through such inventions as the steam engine and mechanical spinning was profitable because employers were able to economise on labour by spending on coal. At that time, no other country had this particular combination of expensive labour and abundant fuel.

Possibilities include the words in green

- We are going to see some examples of a student paraphrasing a text.
- You will have to decide if the paraphrase is successful or not.



“As with innovation, no matter how important identifying opportunity is to the entrepreneurial process, it cannot be all that there is to it, nor can it characterise it uniquely. The entrepreneur cannot stop at simply identifying opportunities. Having identified them, the entrepreneur must pursue them with a suitable innovation. An opportunity is simply the 'mould' against which the market tests new ideas. In fact, actually spotting the opportunity may be delegated to specialist market researchers. The real value is created when that opportunity is exploited by something new which fills the market gap.”

Philip A. Wickham, *Strategic Entrepreneurship* (London: Pitman, 1998), p. 8.

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PARAPHRASE

The entrepreneur cannot stop at simply identifying opportunities. Having identified them, the entrepreneur must pursue them with a suitable innovation. An opportunity is simply the 'mould' against which the market tests new ideas. In fact, actually spotting the opportunity may be delegated to specialist market researchers. The real value is created when that opportunity is exploited by something new which fills the market gap.

Verdict



This is a clear case of plagiarism. These sentences are lifted directly from Wickham's book. Since there are no quotation marks and no citation to indicate the source of the words and ideas, the student who wrote this appears to be guilty of trying to deceive us by pretending to be the author of Wickham's work.



Wickham (1998:8) argues that the entrepreneur cannot stop at simply identifying opportunities. Having identified them, the entrepreneur must pursue them with a suitable innovation. An opportunity is simply the 'mould' against which the market tests new ideas. In fact, actually spotting the opportunity may be delegated to specialist market researchers. The real value is created when that opportunity is exploited by something new which fills the market gap.

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Verdict



This may be a case of plagiarism as bad practice rather than plagiarism with the intent to deceive, but it is still unacceptable. The citation gives Wickham the credit for the ideas. But the failure to put the passage into quotation marks suggests falsely that the words are the student's. This is still plagiarism.



Wickham (1998) argues that no matter how important identifying opportunity is to the entrepreneurial process, it cannot be all that there is to it. The entrepreneur cannot cease at simply identifying opportunities. Spotting the opportunity may be delegated to specialist market researchers. The actual value is created when that opportunity is exploited by something new which fills the market gap (Wickham, 1998:8).

A decorative pattern of light gray and white squares, resembling a pixelated or mosaic effect, located at the bottom of the slide.

Wickham (1998) argues that no matter how important identifying opportunity is to the entrepreneurial process, it cannot be all that there is to it. The entrepreneur cannot cease at simply identifying opportunities. Spotting the opportunity may be delegated to specialist market researchers. The actual value is created when that opportunity is exploited by something new which fills the market gap (Wickham, 1998:8).

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Verdict



This is an edited version of Wickham's paragraph which cuts and pastes the exact words of a selection of his sentences. Although Wickham is cited, this is still plagiarism.



Wickham (1998:8) argues that likewise with innovation, no matter how essential identifying opportunity is to the entrepreneurial practice, it cannot be all that there is to it, nor can it characterise it uniquely. The entrepreneur cannot cease at merely noticing opportunities. The real value is created when that opportunity is exploited by something new which fills the market gap (Wickham, 1998:8).



Wickham (1998:8) argues that likewise with innovation, no matter how essential identifying opportunity is to the entrepreneurial practice, it cannot be all that there is to it, nor can it characterise it uniquely. The entrepreneur cannot cease at merely noticing opportunities. The real value is created when that opportunity is exploited by something new which fills the market gap (Wickham, 1998:8).



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Wickham (1998:8) argues that *likewise* with innovation, no matter how essential identifying opportunity is to the entrepreneurial practice, it cannot be all that there is to it, nor can it characterise it uniquely. The entrepreneur cannot cease at merely noticing opportunities. The real value is created when that opportunity is exploited by something new which fills the market gap (Wickham, 1998:8).

Verdict



The student who wrote this is guilty of plagiarism. The superficial modification of Wickham's writing by changing, for example, an **as** to a **likewise**, and a **stop** to a **cease**, is unacceptable. The student has not changed the **structure** of Wickham's work or enough vocabulary and has therefore plagiarized.



"No matter how important identifying opportunity is to the entrepreneurial process, it cannot be all that there is to it. The entrepreneur cannot stop at simply identifying opportunities. Spotting the opportunity may be delegated to specialist market researchers. The real value is created when that opportunity is exploited by something new which fills the market gap" (Wickham, 1998:8).



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Verdict



Although with the quotation marks and the citation there is no plagiarism here, what the student writes is unacceptable. When quotation marks are used, the text must follow the exact words of the author who is being quoted or dots used to indicate omission. This is not the case here.



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"No matter how important identifying opportunity is to the entrepreneurial process, it cannot be all that there is to it. The entrepreneur cannot stop at simply identifying opportunities...spotting the opportunity may be delegated to specialist market researchers. The real value is created when that opportunity is exploited by something new which fills the market gap." (Wickham, 1998:8).

Use "... to indicate that words have been omitted.

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As with innovation, **no** matter how important identifying opportunity is to the entrepreneurial process, it cannot be all that there is to it, nor can it characterise it uniquely. The entrepreneur cannot stop at simply identifying opportunities. Having identified them, the entrepreneur must pursue them with a suitable innovation. An opportunity is simply the 'mould' against which the market tests new ideas. In fact, actually spotting the opportunity may be delegated to specialist market researchers. The real value is created when that opportunity is exploited by something new which fills the market gap.

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“**[N]**o matter how important identifying opportunity is to the entrepreneurial process, it cannot be all that there is to it. The entrepreneur cannot stop at simply identifying opportunities...spotting the opportunity may be delegated to specialist market researchers. The real value is created when that opportunity is exploited by something new which fills the market gap.” (Wickham, 1998:8).

Use **[]** to indicate a change has been made to the original

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The passage is quoted accurately. It is also identified by quotation marks and a citation. But do these ideas and their expression deserve such extensive quotation? It could be suspected that this is a case of 'quotation laziness' which is designed to enable student writers to escape the effort of summarising someone else's ideas in their own words. Therefore, even though this is not technically plagiarism, a tutor marking such a piece will dislike it.



Searching for and identifying market opportunities cannot be taken as an adequate definition of the entrepreneurial process because this function is one shared by market researchers. Entrepreneurship involves going beyond the identification of a market gap since it includes exploiting that gap with “a suitable innovation” (Wickham, 1998).



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Searching for and identifying market opportunities cannot be taken as an adequate definition of the entrepreneurial process because this function is one shared by market researchers **(NO REFERENCE)**. Entrepreneurship involves going beyond the identification of a market gap since it includes exploiting that gap with '**a suitable innovation**' (Wickham, 1998).

Verdict



The first sentence is plagiarized. This is often the form that accidental plagiarism takes.



Searching for and identifying market opportunities cannot be taken as an adequate definition of the entrepreneurial process because this function is one shared by market researchers (Wickham, 1998). Entrepreneurship involves going beyond the identification of a market gap since it includes exploiting that gap with “a suitable innovation” (Ibid.).

This would be better.

A decorative pattern at the bottom of the slide consisting of a grid of squares in various shades of gray and white, creating a pixelated or mosaic effect.

Wickham (1998) argues that searching for and identifying market opportunities cannot be taken as an adequate definition of the entrepreneurial process. He points out that this function is one shared by market researchers. Wickham also insists that entrepreneurship involves going beyond the identification of a market gap since it includes exploiting that gap with what he calls “a suitable innovation”.



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Verdict



This passage is acceptable because it is not plagiarised. Wickham is credited with the ideas which the student writer summarises, and the words are the writer's own. It is clear from this that the student has understood Wickham's argument. One thing that is missing is a page number for the quotation.



Academic Writing & Assignment

Week 2: Lesson 2



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Today we will look at:



1. How to use direct quotations, effectively and correctly.
2. Using Reporting Verbs and referring to literature

Quotations



Which of the following are good reasons to quote?



1. to give a definition.
2. to ensure that you represent an author's view precisely.
3. to show respect to experts.
4. to provide an interesting and important start or end to your essay.
5. to establish or summarise an author's argument or position.
6. the section that you wish to use is so short that it cannot be paraphrased.
7. you haven't given enough time to reading and making notes, so it seems much easier to 'cut and paste' some quotations into your essay.
8. to state a fact or idea that the author has expressed in a unique and powerful way.

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- 6. the section that you wish to use is so short that it cannot be paraphrased.**
7. you haven't given enough time to reading and making notes, so it seems much easier to 'cut and paste' some quotations into your essay.
- 8. to state a fact or idea that the author has expressed in a unique and powerful way.**

Direct quotations - Why?



Look at the three extracts and decide WHY the student decided to quote from her reading on these occasions.



Direct quotations - Why?



Shaw and Barry (2007:25) define business ethics as “the study of what constitutes right and wrong (or good and bad) human conduct in a business context”. However, Ferrell and Fraedrich et al.(2002:6) see business ethics as more proscriptive, defining it as the “principles and standards that guide behaviour in the world of business”.

Direct quotations - Why?



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To contrast different definitions

Direct quotations - Why?



Secondly, an even stronger argument for the view that good ethics in business do in fact exist is given by Collins (1994:2) and other prominent experts on the subject. This is that “good ethics is synonymous with good management”.

Direct quotations - Why?



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To establish or summarise an author's arguments or positions

Direct quotations - Why?



Secondly, an even stronger argument for the view that good ethics in business do in fact exist is given by Collins (1994:2) and other prominent experts on the subject. This is that “good ethics is synonymous with good management”.

To establish or summarise an author's arguments or positions

Is this done in “a unique and powerful way”?

Direct quotations - Why?



Secondly, an even stronger argument for the view that good ethics in business do in fact exist is given by Collins (1994:2) and other prominent experts on the subject. This is that “good ethics is synonymous with good management”.

Is the referencing clear?

Direct quotations - Why?



Secondly, an even stronger argument for the view that good ethics in business do in fact exist is given by **Collins (1994:2)** and other prominent experts on the subject; this is that “good ethics is synonymous with good management”.

This might be better

Direct quotations - Why?



Secondly, an even stronger argument for the view that good ethics in business do in fact exist is given by Collins (1994:2) and other prominent experts on the subject, which is that “good ethics is synonymous with good management”.

Or this

Direct quotations - Why?



... and led Hughes (2004) to criticise the perceived immoral character of modern business. Others share this view, such as Prindl and Prodham (1994:3), who suggest that “[f]inance as practised in the professions and in industry is seen as a valueless discipline that promotes efficiency without regard to the social consequences which follow from its products”.

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Direct quotations - Why?



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Short quotations



West (1994:15) argues that “what is needed is choice in education”.

West argues that “what is needed is choice in education” (1994:15).

According to **West (1994:15)**, “what is needed is choice in education”.



Longer quotations



Inset and without quotation marks.

According to Perleman:

... school choice has not and will not lead to more productive education because the obsolete technology called school is inherently inelastic. As long as school refers to the traditional structure of buildings and grounds with services delivered in boxes called classrooms to which customers must be transported by car, school choice will be unable to meaningfully alter the quality or efficiency of education **(Perleman, 1992, p.186)**

Reporting Verbs – Meanings?



- A. Shinzo (2011) argues that something as simple as decreasing household meat consumption will have a profound and positive impact on the environment.
- B. A possible explanation lies in the structure of the organisation; Zheng (2014) suggests that radical changes should be openly embraced by senior management in order to be more successfully adopted.
- C. Hadley (2020) claims that the British government could not have done more to prepare for the impact of Brexit.
- D. Although Keppler (2017) admits several limitations to the study, the overall findings support existing academic consensus.
- E. The research found that the majority of the staff were unhappy with the company's salary distribution policies.
- F. Sanchez (2019) maintains that social media is the largest threat to fair politics and should be subject to stricter legal limitations.
- G. The findings published by Bradley et al. (2019) have been largely accepted. Singh and Cooper (2020), however, contend that their wider application is not always applicable.

Reporting Verbs



- A. Shinzo (2011) argues that something as simple as decreasing household meat consumption will have a profound and positive impact on the environment. **2**
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- D. Although Keppler (2017) admits several limitations to the study, the overall findings support existing academic consensus. **4**
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- G. The findings published by Bradley et al. (2019) have been largely accepted. Singh and Cooper (2020), however, contend that their wider application is not always applicable. **3**